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Inside Trump's Great American State Fair

The 16-day birthday extravaganza is — and isn't — what you'd think

By Jim Puzzanghera, Tal Kopan, Sam Brodey, and Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Down the lush green grass of the National Mall, past the 110-foot Ferris wheel and the scaled-down reproduction of President Trump's proposed Triumphal Arch, the Massachusetts booth at the Great American State Fair was essentially a do-it-yourself project.

Its singular attraction? Maple syrup.

That was one of the oddities of the 16-day extravaganza,

which began on Thursday, to mark the nation's 250th birthday. Perhaps fittingly for America in 2026, it opened with a mix of the wholesome, the partisan, and the just plain bizarre.

The fair is a production of Freedom 250, the organization launched by Trump last year to give the type of MAGA-spin on the semiquincentennial festivities — think the White House UFC fight — that the bipartisan, congressionally created America 250 organization would not.

The event, Trump's brainchild, assigns each of the 56 US

FAIR, Page A5



JOE LAMBERTI/WASHINGTON POST

A rodeo was held at the Great American State Fair on the National Mall.

Boston teachers, aides brace for layoffs

Hundreds expected to lose jobs in fall as costs increase, enrollment falls

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Public Schools has notified hundreds of teachers and classroom aides in recent weeks that they may not have jobs in the fall as the city finalized a difficult budget that will require scores of layoffs.

The number of job losses will not be settled until after school starts in September, but more than 500 newer teachers have been notified that their contracts were not being renewed for the next academic year, according to Boston school officials and the Boston Teachers Union.

Teachers' contracts are often not renewed for reasons other than budget cuts, and dozens have already found new positions in Boston. Ultimately, however, hundreds of teachers could be out of a job.

Boston Teachers Union president Erik Berg said an-

LAYOFFS, Page A7

BIG NUMBERS
\$1.7b

The Boston Public Schools' budget for the next school year

\$53m

The shortfall for this past school year at BPS

570

Estimated positions being eliminated across the school system

What time erases, she painstakingly restores



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

At Mount Calvary Cemetery in Roslindale, Emily Galvin scrapes lichen and dirt off a gravestone then uses a small brush (below).

From fading scripts of gravestones, onetime ironworker reclaims the past

By Regina Cole
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Emily Galvin stands before a tall gravestone in a shady corner of Roslindale's Mount Calvary Cemetery. Made of pale gray granite, the angled monolith stands 5½ feet tall and bears the name "Ford," with a carved cross embellished with Celtic knots.

Galvin fits a soft-bristled head to an impact gun and begins to brush surface dirt from



the stone. She rinses it with water and follows it with a wash of pH-neutral cleaner.

"This is what is recommended by the National Cemetery Administration," she explained. "It safely removes mold, mildew, lichen, and dirt, but it does not damage the stone."

For 16 years, Galvin, who lives in Westfield, worked as an ironworker, and for eight of those years, she was a union member. When she was laid off

GRAVESTONES, Page A7

A new great debate emerges for this election

Candidates arguing about scheduling time to argue

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

The biggest debate happening in Massachusetts' primary elections this year is ... over whether to debate.

From a gubernatorial candidate running radio ads urging his opponent to face him, to US Senate hopefuls appearing in a strange cross-party debate without the incumbent, a pattern is repeating itself: Candidates are demanding to take on their better-known or better-liked competitors, with varying levels of success.

In many cases, those eager debaters are being met with silence. That's only made them louder.

"We need a nominee on the Republican side who's been stress-tested and vetted in public life, no surprises," said Brian Shortsleeve, a Republican candidate for governor who booked a radio spot on conservative talk radio, accusing his primary opponent, Mike Minogue, of ducking his debate requests.

"If you can't have a debate among friends in a

DEBATES, Page A10

‘Our slogan should be: “Don’t give AI the bomb.”’

DR. IRA HELFAND, *cofounder of the antinuclear Back from the Brink campaign*

United once more in bid to defuse nuclear threat

Dubbed the ‘Boston brain trust,’ Nobel laureates seek papal push in their mobilization against war

By Robert Weisman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Forty years ago, as idealistic young doctors, they ignited a movement that earned the Nobel Peace Prize and helped rein in the menace of nuclear weapons. Now, in their golden years, with world tensions simmering and the danger of nuclear conflict resurfacing, they're readying a campaign to do it again.

Dr. James Muller and a team of activists he calls the “Boston brain trust” are mobilizing at a time of wars in Ukraine and Iran, nuclear saber-rattling, the collapse of arms control, and the rise of a destabilizing new technology.

And they're seeking help from a powerful ally: Pope Leo XIV.

The team is organizing a global summit next month at the pope's hilltop retreat outside Rome. Its focus: the intertwining threat of artificial intelligence and nuclear war. If the topic sounds ominous, well, that's the point.

"We hope the fusion of AI with nuclear weapons is sufficiently terrifying to create public pressure to outlaw nuclear weapons," Muller said.

The event, formally called the Global Nobel Laureates Assembly on Artificial Intelligence and Nuclear War, is set for July 14-16 at Castel Gandolfo, the pope's summer residence in Italy's Alban Hills. It aims to highlight the mounting dangers of a new nuclear arms race that's revving up even as nations move to embed AI into their war-fighting systems.

Organizers believe a show of support by the American-born pontiff, who has tangled with President Trump on matters of war and peace, has the unique potential to galvanize interest in a resurgent nuclear threat. In late May, the pope warned of the risks of linking AI to nuclear arms in a sweeping encyclical, titled "Magnifica Humanitas" (Latin for magnificent humanity).

How the 83-year-old Muller, a retired cardiologist from Brigham and Women's Hospital, emerged at the center of a push to revive a dormant antinuclear movement

THREAT, Page A6



Sun of liberty

Monday: Sunny, beautiful.
High 75-80, low 65-70.

Tuesday: Hotter, unsettled.
High 87-92, low 70-75.

High tide: Noon.

Sunrise: 5:10. Sunset: 8:25

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Iran again targeted Bahrain and Kuwait with missiles and drones following US airstrikes, and it threatened a halt in peace talks. **A3.**

Duck Tours resumed Sunday in Boston and the Charles River as investigators worked to learn why one of the vehicles tipped onto its side a day earlier, injuring 11 passengers. **B1.**

In a daring mission, NASA is racing to prevent an aging telescope from falling back to Earth, with plans to launch a robotic lifesaver. **A2.**

Examples of outreach between Mayor Michelle Wu and business leaders appear to represent a positive shift in their relationship, Power Play, **D1.**

The Red Sox faltered late, but roared back to sweep the Yankees in series. **C1.**